Proposals

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Contesting for the post of

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Technology Students' Gymkhana

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CONTENTS

01. SOCULT PORTAL EXPANSION & DIGITAL ARCHIVE

02. PG AND RS CULTURAL ASSOCIATION

03. INTRODUCTION OF OPEN IIT CULINARY ARTS

PROPOSAL 1 : SOCULT PORTAL EXPANSION & DIGITAL ARCHIVE

Objective

This initiative aims to build upon the SoCult website currently in development by integrating two critical, high-value modules: a Comprehensive Digital Archive and a Cultural Performance Tracker. While the foundational website will effectively manage society directories, event calendars, and audition notices, this expansion transforms the platform from a standard administrative portal into a strategic, long-term repository for institutional memory and competitive preparation.

Impact

- **Preserves Institutional Memory:** Serves as a dynamic knowledge base by archiving performances, preparatory materials, and behind-the-scenes content, directly aiding future participants in their preparation.
- **Strategic Continuity for Inter-IIT:** Bridges the knowledge gap between graduating seniors and freshers by hosting dedicated exit interviews and strategic breakdowns from past Inter-IIT Captains.
- **Real-Time Transparency:** Delivers accessible, transparent updates on cultural standings across all three tiers of competition: the Inter-Hall General Championship (GC), Open IIT events, and the Inter-IIT Cultural Meet.
- **Unified Ecosystem:** Seamlessly integrates with the upcoming society directories and audition boards to ensure students only need to visit one centralized hub for all SoCult needs.

Implementation Plan

- **Module 1: Comprehensive Digital Archive & Resource Hub (Flagship Addition):** A centralized repository hosting high-quality recordings of past performances, event-specific preparation resources, and behind-the-scenes

documentation. Crucially, this will feature **exclusive, structured video interviews with all outgoing Inter-IIT Cultural Captains**, capturing their strategic insights, contingent management tips, and event-specific advice to guide future contingents.

- **Module 2: Cultural Performance Tracker:** A dynamic dashboard updated post-event to display hall-wise cumulative points and event-wise breakdowns for the GC, Open IIT, and Inter-IIT meets.
- **Integration with the Existing Framework:** Collaborating with the current web development team to embed these two new modules seamlessly into the foundational website (which currently houses the Society Directory, Integrated Event Calendar, and Audition Announcement Board).
- **Tiered Access System:** Verified login portals for Governors, Secretaries, and Captains to upload archival materials and update tracker points directly.

Necessary Groundwork To successfully execute this expansion, we will coordinate directly with the TSG Technology Team currently developing the base website to ensure smooth API and UI integration of the Archive and Tracker modules. A handover of historical GC, Open IIT, and Inter-IIT data from the outgoing committee will be necessary to pre-populate the tracker prior to launch. Additionally, coordination with the Secretary of Photography and Videography and current Inter-IIT Captains will be required to establish a workflow for recording the captain interviews and archiving event media. Discussions have been held with the TSG Technology Coordinator, the General Secretary Social and Cultural Technology Students' Gymkhana, and the Inter-IIT Cup Captain regarding the technical integration, data standardization, and operational impact of this proposal.

Estimated Budget

- **Module Development & Integration:** Minimal, assuming execution by the existing TSG tech volunteers working on

the base site.

- **Server Storage Expansion:** Minimal. All high-capacity archival media (videos, performances) will be hosted on the official Cultural IIT Kharagpur YouTube channel, and preparatory documents will be managed via Google Drive workspaces. These will be seamlessly embedded into the portal, ensuring zero additional hosting costs.
- **Archival Production:** Minimal budget required for basic audio/lighting equipment to record the Inter-IIT Captain interviews.

PROPOSAL 2 : PG AND RS CULTURAL ASSOCIATION

Objective

This proposal aims to establish an inclusive association under the Technology Students' Gymkhana to enhance engagement across all student groups. It seeks to address the limited participation of postgraduate students and research scholars in social and cultural activities.

Impact

- Promotes inclusivity in cultural participation and encourages participation from postgraduate students, research scholars, and undergraduate students.
- Provides platforms to showcase talent and fosters community bonding.
- Bridges engagement across different student groups.

Implementation Plan

- **Organizational Structure**: The association will be led by Executive Heads, specifically a Postgraduate Coordinator and a Research Scholar Coordinator under the Technology Students' Gymkhana. The General Secretary (GSec) of Social and Cultural will act as an off-hand leader to oversee everything. The role of Senior Coordinators will be filled by all non-first-year senior students who excel in management, while 1st Year Postgraduate Students will take on the role of Junior Coordinators. Everyone else will be considered a general member of the association.
- **Collaborative Skill-Building**: The association will conduct workshops in Music, Dance, Writing, Theatre etc., in collaboration with other cultural societies where the

governors of those societies will share their experiences and insights.

Timeline of Multifield Events

- **Open Mic Nights / Thematic Nights**: Held on weekend nights spread out across the year. This flexible scheduling accommodates the academic workload of PG and RS students while maintaining consistent engagement.
- **Cultural Meet**: Scheduled as the single major event in October to foster large-scale participation and healthy competition across different departments.
- **Mega Cultural Evening**: A large-scale event to celebrate the association's talent pool and close out the academic year's cultural calendar.

Necessary Groundwork To successfully establish this framework, the Executive Heads must focus on strategic planning and vision setting. Active liaison with the Technology Students' Gymkhana and existing societies is essential. Furthermore, the Junior Coordinators must execute an outreach and participation drive to ensure strong initial engagement from the postgraduate and research scholar community.

Estimated Budget

- **Open Mic Nights / Thematic Nights**: INR 8,000 - 10,000 per event.
- **Cultural Meet (October)**: INR 15,000 - 20,000.
- **Mega Cultural Evening**: INR 20,000 - 30,000.

Note: Costs include logistics, publicity, and miscellaneous expenses. Budget may be optimized via collaborations and sponsorships.

PROPOSAL 3 : INTRODUCTION OF OPEN IIT CULINARY ARTS EVENT

Objective

Culinary Arts has emerged as a high-stakes competitive category at the Inter-IIT Cultural Meet, yet IIT Kharagpur currently lacks a formal Open IIT framework to identify and train talent. This administrative gap results in several challenges:

- **Lack of Selection Pipeline:** The absence of an Inter-Hall (Open IIT) framework prevents the systematic scouting of grassroots talent, making our performance at the Inter-IIT Cultural Meet dependent on a decentralized selection process rather than a sustainable, hall-based system.
- **Unrecognized Talent:** Despite a diverse student population with deep regional gastronomic knowledge, there is no formal Social and Cultural platform to recognize cooking as both a creative and technical art form.
- **Underutilized Expertise:** The potential for collaboration with the Department of Agricultural and Food Engineering for food safety and technical workshops remains untapped.

The introduction of Open IIT Culinary Arts will provide a centralized, safe, and competitive platform to foster culinary innovation and secure IIT Kharagpur's dominance in the Inter-IIT Cultural Meet.

Implementation

- **Infrastructure and Safety Compliance:** Establish

designated cooking zones in authorized spaces, strictly utilizing induction-based setups to ensure zero fire-risk compliance in accordance with campus norms. Procure a TSG-managed inventory of induction-compatible cookware and digital weighing scales for use during standardized competitions.

- **Competitions:** Launch the "KGP Cook-Off" as an Inter-Hall competition featuring rounds such as the "Mystery Basket Challenge" and "Regional Heritage Fusion." Introduce fireless categories including Mixology (Mocktails) and Food Styling (Cold Plating) to maximize participation while minimizing electrical load.
- **Workshops:** Conduct sessions on food safety (FSSAI standards), professional knife skills, and plating aesthetics in collaboration with senior students from the Food Technology department. Invite alumni from the hospitality industry or professional chefs from local partners to mentor the Inter-IIT core team.
- **Collaborative Projects:** Partner with the Fine Arts Society for food styling and the Photography Society for commercial food documentation and digital content. Collaborate with Spring Fest to feature a "Culinary Showcase" where winning recipes are exhibited to a larger audience.
- **Showcase Events:** Organize a "Taste of KGP" exhibition during cultural weekends to celebrate the diverse regional cuisines represented by various Halls of Residence. Launch a digital archive on the TSG website to document winning recipes, techniques, and safety protocols for future batches.

Impact

1. **Inter-IIT Excellence:** Establish a robust, merit-based pipeline to improve the Institute’s standing and secure podium finishes in the Inter-IIT Culinary Arts Cup.

2. **Fire-Safe Campus:** Mitigate fire hazards by providing a regulated, induction-only alternative to unauthorized cooking in hostel rooms.
3. **Recognition of Talent:** Enable students with niche creative skills to contribute tangibly to their Hall's General Championship (GC) points.
4. **Cultural Inclusivity:** Strengthen the campus social fabric by allowing students from across India to represent their regional identities through a tangible, sensory medium.
5. **Skill Development:** Foster professional-grade standards in hygiene, time management, and resource budgeting among the student community.
6. **Entrepreneurial Exposure:** Provide a launchpad for students interested in the food-tech, hospitality, or FMCG sectors by providing exposure to industry standards.
7. **Long-Term Sustainability:** Build a permanent knowledge repository of recipes and safety manuals. Attract niche sponsorships from kitchenware, induction, and FMCG brands to fund future equipment upgrades.

Necessary Groundwork

To successfully organize the Open IIT Culinary Arts framework, we seek the support of the IIT administration for venue allocation, promotional assistance, and logistical arrangements. The selection of competition categories and safety standards will be done in collaboration with the Governor of Aroma, and professional alumni to ensure a diverse and technically sound program. Preliminary discussions have been held with the Governor of Aroma to assess the feasibility, space requirements.